

OpenAlex Privacy Promise

Last Revised: October 3, 2026

OpenAlex requires API keys so we can keep the service reliable at global scale, spot problems faster, size infrastructure to real demand, and prevent abuse.

Here's our promise:

- **We don't sell your data.** We will never sell API-key usage data to anyone, and we don't use it for advertising.
- **We collect only what we need to run OpenAlex.** This includes the address of each API request, which contains your search terms and filters, and basic technical metadata (for example: timestamps, error codes, performance metrics, and IP address and user agent), all linked to an API key. We keep these request logs for 90 days.
- **We use usage data to improve and protect the service.** We analyze it (mostly in aggregate) to optimize performance and capacity, detect outages and bugs, and prevent abuse.
- **We may contact you about your key.** If we see a security issue, misconfiguration, or unusual error/traffic patterns, we may reach out to help resolve it.
- **We support institutional reporting, without surveillance.** If a university library requests it as part of their process to justify supporting OpenAlex, we can provide aggregated usage summaries for their institution (e.g., # keys, volume over time). We are not building tools to monitor individual researchers.

You can rotate your API key or delete your account yourself in your account settings. Send any other question or request to privacy@openalex.org.

Below you can read our full OpenAlex Privacy Policy.

OpenAlex Privacy Policy

Last Revised: October 3, 2026

OpenAlex is a website featuring web-based tools created and maintained by Impactstory, Inc., doing business as OpenAlex (the "Company," "we," "ours," "us"). We respect and value your privacy, and we are committed to protecting it through our compliance with this privacy policy ("Policy"). This Policy describes the types of information we may collect from you when you visit <https://openalex.org> (the "Site," a component of the Service), when you use or interact with the API, or when you use or interact with any other products, applications, or features provided by us (collectively, the "Service"), as well as our practices for collecting, using, maintaining, protecting, and disclosing that information. Any capitalized terms used but not defined in this Policy are defined in our Terms of Service.

If you do not agree with this Policy, or our other policies and practices, you should not use the Service. This Policy may change from time to time. We will notify you of material changes, but it is your responsibility to check this Policy periodically for updates.

How this Privacy Policy Applies

This Policy applies to information we collect: (1) on this Site; (2) in any electronic communication between you and the Service; (3) through the API or other web-based tools listed on the Site and maintained by us, and (4) when you interact with our applications on third-party websites and services, including AI assistants you connect to your OpenAlex account.

This Policy does NOT apply to information collected by: (1) us offline or through any other means, including on any other website or service operated by any third party (including our affiliates and subsidiaries); or (2) any third party (including our affiliates and subsidiaries), including through any application, website, or content that may link to or be accessible from or through the Service.

Personal Data in the OpenAlex Dataset

OpenAlex is an index of the world's scholarly research. The Service includes a database of bibliographic metadata about scholarly works (records of who published what, where, and when) collected from public sources such as publishers, aggregators, and repositories (see "About the Service" in our Terms of Service). This means OpenAlex may include information about you **even if you have never used the Service**: for example, your name as it appears on the byline of a published paper, your institutional affiliation as stated on that paper, and public identifiers such as an ORCID iD. We refer to this as the "Dataset."

Author profiles. OpenAlex automatically groups works by the same author into an author profile. An author profile is not a biography or a dossier: it is a machine-generated cluster of authorships, bibliographic facts that authors and their publishers have already published to the public scholarly record for the purpose of identifying who wrote what. We aggregate and organize this public record; we do not add private information to it, and we do not knowingly include any sensitive categories of personal data in the Dataset.

Legal basis. Where the GDPR, UK GDPR, or similar laws apply, we process this bibliographic information on the basis of our legitimate interests and those of the international research community (GDPR Art. 6(1)(f)): maintaining a complete, accurate, and openly available record of scholarship, a purpose that could not be achieved if the record were incomplete. We limit that processing to public bibliographic identification metadata, consistent with the safeguards contemplated for research and archiving purposes (GDPR Art. 89(1)).

Corrections. If your author profile misattributes work to you, omits your work, conflates you with another researcher, or states a wrong affiliation or identifier, we want to fix it. Corrections are free and require no legal formalities. See <https://help.openalex.org/how-to/author-profile-privacy> for the fastest paths, including claiming your profile. "Author Profile Claims and Corrections" below describes what we keep when you claim or correct a profile.

Removal requests. Because author profiles aggregate the public record of scholarship, we do not delete author profiles simply on request. If you object to our processing of your bibliographic information, we will consider your request under a balancing test: removal is possible where grounds arising from your particular situation outweigh the legitimate interests of the international research community in a complete scholarly record. Where the balance favors you, we will suppress the profile. Please note that author names appearing on the works themselves are part of the published record supplied by publishers and repositories; corrections or removals at that level must be made by the publisher or repository of record, and OpenAlex will reflect them once made.

How to submit a request. Send correction requests through the channels in <https://help.openalex.org/how-to/author-profile-privacy>. Send removal or objection requests, or any other request concerning personal data in the Dataset, to **privacy@openalex.org**, describing your particular situation. We will acknowledge your request promptly and aim to respond substantively within 30 days. If you are in the EU or UK and are unsatisfied with our response, you have the right to complain to your data protection supervisory authority; we would appreciate the chance to resolve your concern first.

Types of Information We Collect & How We Collect It

Depending on how you use the Service, we, along with any third-party companies or individuals with whom we work, may collect information directly and voluntarily from you when you use the Service or contact us directly. We may collect Personal Information and Non-Personal Information, depending on how you use the Service and what information you provide to us.

Personal Information. Personal Information is generally any information that can be used to identify you individually, either by itself or in conjunction with other information.

Personal Information may include, without limitation:

- Contact Information, such as your name and email address
- Information about the organization for which you work;
- Demographic or location information, when that information is linked to other Personal Information or Non-Personal Information that allows an individual to be identified;
- Financial information, billing preferences, and your unique API key.

Non-Personal Information. Non-Personal Information includes information that is about you or about your use of the Service but does not identify you personally, such as:

- IP addresses
- Anonymous usage data;
- Referring/exit pages and URLs;
- Browser or platform type;
- Equipment used to access the Service;
- Language preferences;
- Preferences you submit and preferences that are generated based on data you submit; and
- The date and time of user requests.

How We Collect Non-Personal Information. We generally collect Non-Personal Information through automatic data collection technologies, which are described in more detail below.

*The preceding lists of Personal Information and Non-Personal Information we may collect are illustrative, not exhaustive. When information in these lists is linked to your account or API key, as it is in our request logs, we treat it as Personal Information.

The paragraphs below describe what we collect in specific parts of the Service.

Sign-up and security. When you sign up, we record your IP address, your email's domain and the outcome, to stop automated and bulk sign-ups, and we may block or disable accounts that look automated. We record the dates and times you visit the website while signed in. If you belong to an organization account, its owners can see the most recent one.

Request logs. For every API request, including the ones our website and connected AI assistants make for you, we log the time, the full request address (which contains your search terms and filters), your API key, IP address, browser or client name, the referring page, the response status and the credits used. If you put an email address in the mailto parameter, we log it too. We use these logs to run, secure and bill the API, to fix problems and to improve search, and we delete them after 90 days. Requests that a connected AI assistant makes for you are used only to answer them and to run and secure the service, never for search research. Any copy we make of these logs for analysis is deleted within the same 90 days; after that we keep only aggregate counts that identify no one. Because the website sends your API key when you are signed in, your searches on openalex.org are linked to your account in these logs.

Purchases. When you buy credits, Stripe, our payment processor, collects your payment details and, for an invoice, your billing address and tax ID. We never see your full card number. We keep a record of each purchase: the amount, credits, date, card brand and last four digits, and the Stripe invoice.

Organization accounts. If your verified email address is on a domain an organization account has registered, we add you to that organization. Its owners can see your name, email address, when you joined and last signed in, the corrections you make, and, if they give you a high-volume key, that key's usage. Owners of some organization accounts can also look up accounts on their domains by name or email address, to give them a high-volume key.

Job applicants. If you apply for a job with us, we collect what you submit (name, contact details, location, profile links such as LinkedIn and GitHub, education, résumé and answers) and our evaluation of it, which may use AI tools. We use it only to consider you for the role.

Information about other people. Some features let you give us someone else's details: inviting a colleague to your organization, nominating someone for our Community Advisory Board, requesting access for colleagues, or sending an export notice to another address. We use those details only for that purpose.

Author Profile Claims and Corrections

Author profile claims. If you claim an OpenAlex author profile, we link it to your account and keep a claim record: the evidence you gave us (usually a link to a web page, or the name of the AI assistant you claimed through), the email address on your account at the time, the dates, our decision, how we verified the claim and the reason for the decision. We use the record to decide the claim and to let you correct that profile. Anyone can see that a profile has been claimed, but not by whom. OpenAlex staff can see who claimed it. You can unclaim a profile in your account settings, and deleting your account deletes your claim. We keep only a history, under your account ID, of which profile was claimed and when it was claimed and unclaimed.

Linking your ORCID iD. If you link your ORCID iD by signing in to ORCID, we keep the iD and the date you linked it, and we use it to approve a claim on the profile that carries that iD. We keep no ORCID sign-in tokens. You can unlink your ORCID iD in your account settings.

Checking claims. We decide claims automatically, usually within minutes, and no person reviews a decision before it takes effect. We approve a claim when something verified on your account ties you to the profile: an email address at a recognized research institution, an ORCID iD you linked that matches the profile's, or one of your verified email addresses shown on the public page you link to, on the profile's public ORCID record, or in the author contact details of papers on the profile. To read the page you link to we use a web-fetching service, which receives only the link. When our rules can't tell what kind of page it is, we send two AI model providers the page's address and title, short passages around your email address, and the email address itself, and ask them only what kind of page it is. Those passages can include other details shown on the same page. We keep a record of each check: the link, the page we reached, how your email address matched

and the AI models' answers. If we can't approve a claim, we tell you why. You can send a different link, add a university email address, link your ORCID iD, or ask a person to review the decision at support@openalex.org.

Corrections you submit. When you correct OpenAlex data, for example by adding a work to your author profile, removing one that isn't yours, or matching an affiliation string to your institution, we keep the correction with your account: what you changed, the old and new values, and when. Once applied, the corrected value becomes part of the public Dataset, released under CCo. Your name and account are not published with it. Owners and curators of an organization account can see the corrections made by its members. If you delete your account, we delete your corrections and the data returns to its previous state.

Until October 1, 2026, a separate service at corrections.openalex.org took corrections to works, journals and links, and kept each submitter's email address. That service is closed. We keep a private copy of its records, including those email addresses, because the corrections they hold are still applied to the Dataset.

Connecting an AI Assistant

You can connect an AI assistant, such as ChatGPT or Claude, to your OpenAlex account. When you approve the connection, we record which assistant you connected and store an authorization, with your contact details and API key encrypted, for up to 90 days or until you disconnect. The assistant's requests run on your API key and are logged like any other API request (see "Request logs"). For each tool the assistant uses, we also record the tool, your account ID, whether it worked, how long it took and the credits it used, and keep that for three months.

We send the assistant only the results of the requests it makes. When it asks, those results include your name, email addresses, organization and role, claimed author profile, claim and its status, and the corrections you have made. We never receive your conversation with the assistant. Its provider handles our results under its own privacy policy.

AI Processing of Text You Send

Some features send text you give us to an AI model provider to do what you asked: a CV you upload, to find your publications; text you send to the API's /text endpoints, to suggest topics, keywords or a query; semantic-search queries, to find matching works; and the text of a works search with the title, source, year and type of its top results, to put the most relevant results first. Search text goes to the provider without your account, API key or IP address. We send only what the feature needs and don't keep uploaded CV files.

Automatic Data Collection and How We Use It

For certain components of the Service, we may use automatic data collection technologies and analytics tools (such as Plausible.io) to collect information from your device or browser about your equipment, browsing actions, and patterns when you access, use, and interact with the Service. We use this information to maintain the security and operation of the Service, and to gain insights about the functionality and use of the Service in order to improve the Service.

We use Plausible for cookieless page statistics, Sentry to catch website errors (it receives your browser details and the pages you visited when an error happens, but not your IP address), Cloudflare to deliver the site and to check, invisibly, that visitors are not bots, Zendesk for the support widget, and Google Fonts. Each receives your IP address and browser details when your browser contacts it. Pages that list the members of an organization account show Gravatar pictures, so Gravatar receives a coded form (a hash) of each listed member's email address.

The website sets no cookies of its own. It keeps your sign-in key, a copy of your account details, your preferences and unsent drafts in your browser's local storage, and removes the sign-in key and account copy when you sign out. We use no advertising trackers.

Location Information

We may, from time to time, track user location through IP logging for security and fraud prevention purposes. Use location may also be tracked in connection with our use of automatic data collection technologies.

Do Not Track Disclosure

Most web browsers and some mobile operating systems and mobile applications include a Do-Not-Track ("DNT") feature or setting you can activate to signal your privacy preference not to have data about your online browsing activities monitored and collected. We do not track information about users or visitors to the Site over time and across third party websites to provide targeted advertising and there is no uniform technology standard for recognizing and implementing DNT signals, so we do not respond to Do Not Track (DNT) signals. However, some third party sites do keep track of your browsing activities when they serve you content, which enables them to tailor what they present to you. You may set your web browser to transmit a "Do Not Track" signal to websites and online services you visit. For more information on Do Not Track, please visit www.allaboutdnt.com.

Information from Minors

We do not knowingly collect personal information from persons under the age of 18. By using the Services, you represent that you are at least 18 or that you are the parent or guardian of such a minor and consent to such minor using the Services. If you have reason to believe that a minor has provided personal information through the Site, please contact us by email at privacy@openalex.org. If we learn we have collected or received personal information from a minor under 18 without verification of parental consent, we will delete that information.

How & Why We Use Your Information

The ways we use and disclose your Personal Information as described in this Policy are necessary for our legitimate business interests or for reasons related to an agreement between you and Impactstory. Our legitimate business interests include without limitation, facilitating the Service, evaluating and maintaining the functionality and security of the Service, developing and offering additional features and services to benefit all Users, and for purposes related to furthering the sales and use of our technology and services.

In situations where we have collected your Personal Information, we may use it to:

- Communicate with you.
- For example, we may use your email address to contact you in response to your question or request, solicit feedback from you about the Service, provide technical support and service update notices, and inform you about new features and tools we may offer.
- Facilitate and carry out the functions of the Service;
- Decide author profile claims and apply the corrections you submit to the Dataset;
- Carry out the requests of AI assistants you connect to your account;
- Consider your application if you apply for a job with us;
- To carry out our obligations and enforce our rights arising from any contracts entered into between you and us, including for billing and collection;
- Enforce our Terms of Service and other policies, and preventing prohibited or illegal activities, or violations of our Terms of Service;
- Improve the Service;
- For example, we may identify ways to improve the Service based on your IP address activity or support requests you submit.

- To allow you to participate in interactive features on the Site;
- Administer referral programs, rewards, surveys, contests, or other promotional activities or sponsored events;
- Comply with our legal obligations, resolve any disputes that we may have with any of our users, and enforce our agreements;
- For any other purpose disclosed to you and to which you consent.

We use Non-Personal Information to help us to track trends and analyze use patterns on the Site, and to assess and improve the Service. We log IP addresses and may associate them with an API key for security, abuse prevention, debugging, and service reliability (see "Request logs" above). We do not use this information for advertising or cross-site tracking.

Impactstory may compile information and data in an aggregated form related to the performance, operation, and use of the Service (collectively, "Data Reports"), and may use such Data Reports for security, statistical, or operations analyses, and for research and development purposes. Data Reports shall not incorporate any information in a form that would identify any individual. Impactstory retains all right, title, and interest in and to the Data Reports, including all associated intellectual property rights.

If you are located in the EU or UK, this section applies to you.

The General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) and UK GDPR require us to explain the valid legal bases we rely on in order to process your personal information. As such, we may rely on the following legal bases to process your personal information:

Consent. We may process your information if you have given us permission (i.e., consent) to use your personal information for a specific purpose. You can withdraw your consent at any time.

Performance of a Contract. We may process your personal information when we believe it is necessary to fulfill our contractual obligations to you, including providing our Services or at your request prior to entering into a contract with you.

Legitimate Interests. We may process your information when we believe it is reasonably necessary to achieve our legitimate business interests and those interests do not outweigh your interests and fundamental rights and freedoms.

Legal Obligations. We may process your information where we believe it is necessary for compliance with our legal obligations, such as to cooperate with a law enforcement body or regulatory agency, exercise or defend our legal rights, or disclose your information as evidence in litigation in which we are involved.

Vital Interests. We may process your information where we believe it is necessary to protect your vital interests or the vital interests of a third party, such as situations involving potential threats to the safety of any person.

If you are located in the Canada, this section applies to you.

We may process your information if you have given us specific permission (i.e., express consent) to use your personal information for a specific purpose, or in situations where your permission can be inferred (i.e., implied consent). You can withdraw your consent at any time.

In some exceptional cases, we may be legally permitted under applicable law to process your information without your consent, including, for example

If collection is clearly in the interests of an individual and consent cannot be obtained in a timely way

For investigations and fraud detection and prevention

For business transactions provided certain conditions are met

If it is contained in a witness statement and the collection is necessary to assess, process, or settle an insurance claim

For identifying injured, ill, or deceased persons and communicating with next of kin

If we have reasonable grounds to believe an individual has been, is, or may be victim of financial abuse

If it is reasonable to expect collection and use with consent would compromise the availability or the accuracy of the information and the collection is reasonable for purposes related to investigating a breach of an agreement or a contravention of the laws of Canada or a province

If disclosure is required to comply with a subpoena, warrant, court order, or rules of the court relating to the production of records

If it was produced by an individual in the course of their employment, business, or profession and the collection is consistent with the purposes for which the information was produced

If the collection is solely for journalistic, artistic, or literary purposes

If the information is publicly available and is specified by the regulations

How We Disclose Your Information

We may disclose any Personal Information or Non-Personal Information you share with us to certain third parties for the purpose of facilitating and carrying out the Service. Our service providers fall into these categories:

- hosting, databases and data processing;
- delivering, securing and metering the website and API;
- search;
- sending email;
- payments;
- customer support;
- error monitoring and website statistics;
- web fonts and profile pictures;
- checking author profile claims (a web-fetching service and AI model providers);
- reading CVs you upload and powering the API's text features (AI model providers); and
- internal staff messaging.

We name each provider, what it receives and why in "Our Service Providers" near the end of this Policy. Those vendors use your Personal Information only at our direction and in accordance with our Privacy Policy. We may disclose aggregated, anonymous information about our users and any information that does not identify any specific individual for business purposes.

Some information also reaches other people because you asked for it or because a feature works that way. When you connect an AI assistant, we send it the results of the requests it makes (see "Connecting an AI Assistant"). Owners of an organization account you belong to can see the information described in "Organization accounts". Corrections you submit become part of the public Dataset, without your name or account (see "Corrections you submit").

We may also disclose your personal information: (1) to comply with any court order, law, or legal process, including to respond to any government or regulatory request; (2) to ensure compliance with our Terms of Service and other agreements, such as billing; (3) to protect the rights, property, or safety of Impactstory, our customers, or others; and (4) in connection with or during negotiations of, any merger, sale of company assets, financing, or acquisition of all or a portion of our business to another company. Except as otherwise stated in this Policy, we do not sell, trade, rent, or otherwise share your Personal Information with third parties without your consent.

Data Security

We implement security measures designed to protect your information from unauthorized access, use, or disclosure. We protect your information from potential security breaches by implementing certain technological security measures including encryption, firewalls and secure socket layer technology. However, these measures do not guarantee that your information will not be accessed, disclosed, altered or destroyed by breach of such firewalls and secure server software. By using our Service, you acknowledge that you understand and agree to assume these risks, and Impactstory shall not be responsible for the circumvention of any of the Service's privacy settings or security measures. If you have a unique API key we urge you to take steps to keep your API key protected from unauthorized use by others.

Your Controls

In your account settings you can change your name and email addresses, link or unlink your ORCID iD, unclaim your author profile, turn off alerts, rotate your API key and delete your account. Deleting your account deletes your profile information, email addresses, API key, sign-in history, saved searches, alerts, collections, exports, purchase records, author profile claim and the corrections you made. A few records outlast your account for the periods listed in "Data Retention". If you have applied for a job with us, write to privacy@openalex.org to delete your account.

Rotating your API key disconnects every AI assistant you have connected. Connections also end when the assistant disconnects or after 90 days. For a copy of your data, or anything else, write to privacy@openalex.org.

Your Rights Related to Your Information

In some regions (like the EEA, UK, Switzerland, and Canada), you have certain rights under applicable data protection laws. These may include the right (i) to request access and obtain a copy of your personal information, (ii) to request rectification or erasure; (iii) to restrict the processing of your personal information; (vi) if applicable, to data portability; and (vii) not to be subject to automated decision-making. In certain circumstances, you may also have the right to object to the processing of your personal information. We will consider and act upon any request in accordance with the applicable data protection laws.

We make two kinds of automated decisions about you: we screen sign-ups to block automated and bulk accounts, and we decide author profile claims (see "Checking claims"). You can ask a person to review either decision by writing to support@openalex.org.

You may request a copy of your personal data from us at any time. If you request a copy of your data, we will provide you a copy in a structured, electronic format.

You may also request that your personal data be corrected if you believe it is incorrect or incomplete, or that it be deleted entirely. We will delete your personal data upon your request if you send us a request with a description of the basis for your request; however, we may first restrict processing of your data as permitted under applicable law in order to assess your request prior to any deletion of data. The rights described in this section apply to personal information we have collected **from you or about your use of the Service** (such as account information, API keys, and usage data).

Bibliographic information in the OpenAlex Dataset, including author profiles, is governed by the section "Personal Data in the OpenAlex Dataset" above.

Finally, you may object to our processing of your personal data, or request that we restrict the processing of your personal data. If you request that we restrict processing of your data, we will stop processing your data, but we may still store your data as permitted under applicable law pending an assessment of your request.

We may not be able to delete your personal data except by also deleting your account, if applicable. We may not be able to accommodate a request to change or delete information if we the change would violate any law or legal requirement, or if such change would cause the information to be incorrect.

You may revoke consent to our processing activities that are based on your consent, if and when applicable. If you withdraw your consent, we may not be able to provide certain products or services to you. We will advise you if this is the case at the time you withdraw your consent.

Please direct all requests related to your information to privacy@openalex.org.

If you are a resident of the European Economic Area or UK and you believe we are unlawfully processing your personal information, you also have the right to complain to your local data protection supervisory authority. You can find their contact details here: https://ec.europa.eu/justice/data-protection/bodies/authorities/index_en.htm

Rights Available to Certain United States Residents

Residents of certain states within the United States are granted specific rights related to access and processing of personal information.

What categories of personal information do we collect?

We have collected the following categories of personal information in the past twelve months:

- Identifiers. Examples: Contact details, such as real name, alias, postal address, telephone or mobile contact number, unique personal identifier, online identifier, Internet Protocol address, email address, and account name
- C. Commercial information: records of the credits you buy
- E. Internet or other similar network activity: records of your API requests, including your search terms, and of your visits to the website while signed in
- H. Professional or employment-related information: the organization you work for and your role there, and job applicants' work history
- I. Education information: from job applicants only
- K. Sensitive personal information: sign-in credentials and API keys only

We have NOT collected the following categories of information in the past twelve months:

- A. Personal information as defined in the California Consumer Records statute
- B. Protected classification characteristics under state or federal law
- D. Biometric information
- F. Geolocation data
- G. Audio, electronic, visual, thermal, olfactory, or similar information
- J. Inferences drawn from personal information

How do we use and share your personal information?

See "How and Why We Use Your Information" above.

Will your information be shared with anyone else?

We may disclose your personal information with our service providers pursuant to a written contract between us and each service provider.

We may use your personal information for our own business purposes, such as for undertaking research for technological development and demonstration. This is not considered "selling" your personal information.

We disclosed the categories of personal information above to our service providers for business purposes. We have not sold or shared personal information. We will not sell or share personal information in the future belonging to website visitors, users, and other consumers

See also, "How We Disclose Your Information" above.

California Residents

California Civil Code Section 1798.83, also known as the "Shine The Light" law permits our users who are California residents to request and obtain from us, once a year and free of charge, information about categories of personal information (if any) we disclosed to third parties for direct marketing purposes and the names and addresses of all third parties with which we shared personal information in the immediately preceding calendar year. If you are a California resident and would like to make such a request, please submit your request in writing to us using the contact information provided below.

If you are under 18 years of age, reside in California, and have a registered account with the Services, you have the right to request removal of unwanted data that you publicly post on the Services. To request removal of such data, please contact us using the contact information provided below and include the email address associated with your account and a statement that you reside in California. We will make sure the data is not publicly displayed on the Services, but please be aware that the data may not be completely or comprehensively removed from all our systems (e.g., backups, etc.).

CCPA Privacy Notice

This section applies only to California residents. Under the California Consumer Privacy Act (CCPA), you have the rights listed below.

The California Code of Regulations defines a "residents" as:

(1) every individual who is in the State of California for other than a temporary or transitory purpose and (2) every individual who is domiciled in the State of California who is outside the State of California for a temporary or transitory purpose

All other individuals are defined as "non-residents."

If this definition of "resident" applies to you, we must adhere to certain rights and obligations regarding your personal information

Your rights with respect to your personal data

Right to request deletion of the data: Request to delete

You can ask for the deletion of your personal information. If you ask us to delete your personal information, we will respect your request and delete your personal information, subject to certain exceptions provided by law, such as (but not limited to) the exercise by another consumer of his or her right to free speech, our compliance requirements resulting from a legal obligation, or any processing that may be required to protect against illegal activities.

Right to be informed: Request to know

Depending on the circumstances, you have a right to know:

- whether we collect and use your personal information;
- the categories of personal information that we collect;
- the purposes for which the collected personal information is used;
- whether we sell or share personal information to third parties;
- the categories of personal information that we sold, shared, or disclosed for a business purpose;
- the categories of third parties to whom the personal information was sold, shared, or disclosed for a business purpose;
- the business or commercial purpose for collecting, selling, or sharing personal information; and
- the specific pieces of personal information we collected about you.

In accordance with applicable law, we are not obligated to provide or delete consumer information that is de-identified in response to a consumer request or to re-identify individual data to verify a consumer request.

Right to Non-Discrimination for the Exercise of a Consumer Privacy Rights

We will not discriminate against you if you exercise your privacy rights.

Right to Limit Use and Disclosure of Sensitive Personal Information

We use sensitive personal information, such as your sign-in credentials and API key, only to provide the Service.

Verification process

Upon receiving your request, we will need to verify your identity to determine you are the same person about whom we have the information in our system. These verification efforts require us to ask you to provide information so that we can match it with information you have previously provided us. For instance, depending on the type of request you submit, we may ask you to provide certain information so that we can match the information you provide with the information we already have on file, or we may contact you through a communication method (e.g., phone or email) that you have previously provided to us. We may also use other verification methods as the circumstances dictate.

We will only use personal information provided in your request to verify your identity or authority to make the request. To the extent possible, we will avoid requesting additional information from you for the purposes of verification. However, if we cannot verify your identity from the information already maintained by us, we may request that you provide additional information for the purposes of verifying your identity and for security or fraud- prevention purposes. We will delete such additionally provided information as soon as we finish verifying you.

Other privacy rights

You may object to the processing of your personal information.

You may request correction of your personal data if it is incorrect or no longer relevant, or ask to restrict the processing of the information.

You can designate an authorized agent to make a request under the CCPA on your behalf. We may deny a request from an authorized agent that does not submit proof that they have been validly authorized to act on your behalf in accordance with the CCPA.

You may request to opt out from future selling or sharing of your personal information to third parties. Upon receiving an opt-out request, we will act upon the request as soon as feasibly possible, but no later than fifteen (15) days from the date of the request submission.

To exercise these rights, you can email privacy@openalex.org, visit <https://openalex.org/help>, or refer to the contact details at the bottom of this document. If you have a complaint about how we handle your data, we would like to hear from you.

Colorado Residents

This section applies only to Colorado residents. Under the Colorado Privacy Act (CPA), you have the rights listed below. However, these rights are not absolute, and in certain cases we may decline your request as permitted by law.

Right to be informed whether or not we are processing your personal data

Right to access your personal data

Right to correct inaccuracies in your personal data

Right to request deletion of your personal data

Right to obtain a copy of the personal data you previously shared with us

Right to opt out of the processing of your personal data if it is used for targeted advertising, the sale of personal data, or profiling in furtherance of decisions that produce legal or similarly significant effects ("profiling")

To submit a request to exercise these rights described above, please email privacy@openalex.org or visit <https://openalex.org/help>.

If we decline to take action regarding your request and you wish to appeal our decision, please email us at privacy@openalex.org. Within forty-five (45) days of receipt of an appeal, we will inform you in writing of any action taken or not taken in response to the appeal, including a written explanation of the reasons for the decisions.

Connecticut Residents

This section applies only to Connecticut residents. Under the Connecticut Data Privacy Act (CTDPA), you have the rights listed below. However, these rights are not absolute, and in certain cases we may decline your request as permitted by law.

Right to be informed whether or not we are processing your personal data

Right to access your personal data

Right to correct inaccuracies in your personal data

Right to request deletion of your personal data

Right to obtain a copy of the personal data you previously shared with us

Right to opt out of the processing of your personal data if it is used for targeted advertising, the sale of personal data, or profiling in furtherance of decisions that produce legal or similarly significant effects ("profiling").

To submit a request to exercise these rights described above, please email privacy@openalex.org or visit <https://openalex.org/help>.

If we decline to take action regarding your request and you wish to appeal our decision, please email us at privacy@openalex.org. Within sixty (60) days of receipt of an appeal, we will inform you in writing of any action taken or not taken in response to the appeal, including a written explanation of the reasons for the decisions.

Virginia Residents

Under the Virginia Consumer Data Protection Act (VCDPA):

"Consumer" means a natural person who is a resident of the Commonwealth acting only in an individual or household context. It does not include a natural person acting in a commercial or employment context.

"Personal data" means any information that is linked or reasonably linkable to an identified or identifiable natural person.

"Personal data" does not include de-identified data or publicly available information.

"Sale of personal data" means the exchange of personal data for monetary consideration.

If this definition of "consumer" applies to you, we must adhere to certain rights and obligations regarding your personal data.

Your rights with respect to your personal data

Right to be informed whether or not we are processing your personal data

Right to access your personal data

Right to correct inaccuracies in your personal data

Right to request deletion of your personal data

Right to obtain a copy of the personal data you previously shared with us

Right to opt out of the processing of your personal data if it is used for targeted advertising, the sale of personal data, or profiling in furtherance of decisions that produce legal or similarly significant effects ("profiling")

Exercise your rights provided under the Virginia VCDPA. You may contact us by email at privacy@openalex.org or visit <https://openalex.org/help>. If you are using an authorized agent to exercise your rights, we may deny a request if the authorized agent does not submit proof that they have been validly authorized to act on your behalf.

Verification process

We may request that you provide additional information reasonably necessary to verify you and your consumer's request. If you submit the request through an authorized agent, we may need to collect additional information to verify your identity before processing your request.

Upon receiving your request, we will respond without undue delay, but in all cases, within forty-five (45) days of receipt. The response period may be extended once by forty-five (45) additional days when reasonably necessary. We will inform you of any such extension within the initial 45-day response period, together with the reason for the extension.

Right to appeal

If we decline to take action regarding your request, we will inform you of our decision and reasoning behind it. If you wish to appeal our decision, please email us at privacy@openalex.org. Within sixty (60) days of receipt of an appeal, we will inform you in writing of any action taken or not taken in response to the appeal, including a written explanation of the reasons for the decisions. If your appeal is denied, you may contact the Attorney General to submit a complaint

Failure to Provide Personal Information

If you fail to provide Personal Information when it is required by law or necessary for us to perform our obligations under a contract with you, we may not be able to perform the contract. For example, if you fail to provide us with your billing information to pay for a Data Feed Subscription, we may not be able to provide you with the Data Feed Subscription you requested.

Data Retention

We keep logs for 90 days. Everything else we keep for the periods below.

Information	How long we keep it
Your account: profile information, email addresses, API key, linked ORCID iD, sign-in history, saved searches and alerts, collections, export list, author profile claim, corrections and purchase records	Until you delete your account
API request logs, and any copies of them	90 days
AI-assistant connections	Up to 90 days, or until you disconnect; records of each tool the assistant used, 3 months
Sign-up attempts (IP address and email domain)	90 days
Email delivery and bounce records (your email address and what happened to each message)	90 days, except that if a message to you bounces permanently or you report it as spam, we keep your address on a do-not-send list so we never email it again
Claim check records (the link, the page we reached, how your email address matched, the AI models' answers)	Until the claim or your account is deleted
Profile claim history (your account ID, the profile, and when it was claimed and unclaimed)	Permanently
Job applications	2 years after a decision
Support conversations	Until you ask us to delete them, at privacy@openalex.org

Information	How long we keep it
Records of the retired corrections service, including submitters' email addresses	As long as the corrections they hold remain applied to the Dataset
Database backups	A few days after the data is deleted from the live database

We may also retain and use your Personal Information as necessary to satisfy any legal requirements, including enforcing our rights and agreements and resolving disputes. We will try to delete your information promptly consistent with these data retention practices. However, there might be some technical delay involved in deleting information from our servers, and backed-up versions might still exist after deletion. In addition, we do not delete any data that has been rendered completely anonymous or maintained in de-identified, aggregated form with data of other users (such as usage trend reports).

To determine the appropriate retention period for Personal Information, we consider the amount, nature, and sensitivity of the personal data, the potential risk of harm from unauthorized use or disclosure of your personal data, the purposes for which we process your personal data and whether we can achieve those purposes through other means, and the applicable legal requirements.

International Transfers of Data

Impactstory's principal business operations are conducted in the United States, but the Service may be available to users outside the United States. If you are visiting this Site from a country other than the United States, your communications with us may result in the transfer of information outside of the country from which you reside or use the Service. By visiting the Site, communicating electronically with us, and/or using the Service, you consent to any and all such transfers.

Links to Other Websites

As part of the Service, we may provide links to or compatibility with other websites or applications. However, we are not responsible for the privacy practices employed by those websites or the information or content they contain. This Policy applies solely to information collected by us through the Site and the Service. Therefore, this Policy does not apply to your use of a third party website accessed by selecting a link on our Site or via our Service. If you use the Service through another website or application, that provider's privacy policy governs what it collects; this Policy still governs what we collect. We encourage our users to read the privacy statements of other websites before proceeding to use them.

Changes to Our Privacy Policy

We reserve the right to change this Policy and our Terms of Service at any time. We will notify you of significant changes to our Policy by sending a notice to the primary email address specified in your account or by placing a prominent notice on our site. Significant changes will go into effect thirty (30) days following such notification. Non-material changes or clarifications will take effect immediately. You should periodically check the Site and this privacy page for updates.

In the event we undergo a business transaction such as a merger, acquisition by another company, or sale of all or a portion of our assets, your Personal Information may be among the assets transferred. You acknowledge and consent that such transfers may occur and are permitted by this Privacy Policy, and that any acquirer of our assets may continue to process your Personal Information as set forth in this Privacy Policy.

Our Service Providers

These are the service providers that receive Personal Information from us, what each receives, and why.

Provider	What it receives	Why
Cloudflare	Every API request, with its API key, IP address, full request address including search terms, browser or client name and referring page; your AI-assistant connections and a record of each tool they use; signals from your browser for bot checks; all website traffic; text of CVs you upload, in transit	Delivering, securing and metering the website and API; bot checks; logs; running our AI-assistant server and CV reader
Heroku (Salesforce)	Our accounts database, with all account data; website and API server logs, which include request addresses	Hosting
Amazon Web Services	Export files you request; text you send to the API's /text endpoints	Exports; topic suggestions
Elastic	Search queries, and a log of queries that take two seconds or more	Search engine
Databricks	Read access to our accounts database; the account ID behind each correction; semantic-search queries; records of the retired corrections service, including submitters' email addresses	Applying corrections to the Dataset; semantic search
Postmark	Your email address and the messages we send you: sign-in links, receipts, invitations, and job-application receipts with résumés	Sending email
Mailgun	Your email address and the messages we send you: saved-search alerts, export notices and claim decisions; staff summaries of approved claims, with claimants' email addresses	Sending email
Stripe	Your email address and account ID; your card details; for an invoice, your billing address and tax ID	Payments
Zendesk	Your support requests (account ID, email address, name and message); device identifiers from the website's support widget	Customer support
Sentry	Website errors, with page addresses and recent browser activity; API errors, with request addresses	Error monitoring
Plausible	Page addresses, outbound and download clicks, and JavaScript errors, without cookies	Website statistics
Google (Fonts)	Your IP address and browser details	Web fonts
Automattic (Gravatar, Jetpack)	Hashed email addresses of organization members; visitor statistics for blog.openalex.org	Profile pictures; blog statistics
Slack	The email address and comments of people who ask us to add a repository	Alerts to our staff
Zyte	Links you send as evidence for a claim	Fetching the linked page
Anthropic	For claim checks, your email address and short passages of the page you linked; text of CVs you upload	Checking claims; finding publications in CVs
TypeSafe AI	For claim checks, your email address and short passages of the page you linked; for search ranking, the text of a works search and the title, source, year and type of its top results, without your account, API key or IP address	Checking claims; ordering search results
OpenAI	Text you send to the API's /text endpoints	Suggesting queries and related works
Modal	Text you send to the API's /text keywords endpoint	Suggesting keywords
GitHub	Copies of support conversations (account ID, email address, name and message) and our staff's internal working files	Storing our internal records
ORCID	Your sign-in, when you link your ORCID iD (it happens at ORCID); ORCID iDs we look up to check claims	Linking your ORCID iD; checking claims

Contact Us

You have the right to make a complaint at any time to your local data protection authority if you have concerns regarding your rights under applicable law. We would, however, appreciate the chance to address your concerns so please contact us first so that we can discuss a resolution with you directly.

If you have any questions regarding this Policy or our data processing practices, please contact us by sending an email to **privacy@openalex.org**. This includes requests concerning personal data in the OpenAlex Dataset (including author profiles).

Our full details are:

Full name of legal entity: Impactstory, Inc.

Individual Contact: Jason Priem

Email address: privacy@openalex.org

Postal address: 500 Westover Dr #8234 Sanford, NC 27330-8941

Telephone number: 778-848-4724